***Board 1***
North Deals
None Vul

♠ K 8 6
♥ A 9 3
♦ K Q 8
♣ A K J 2

♠ J 10 9 5 3
♥ 8
♦ J 10 7 3
♣ Q 7 3

♠ A Q 2
♥ 10 6
♦ 6 5 4
♣ 10 8 6 5 4

♠ 7 4
♥ K Q J 7 5 4 2
♦ A 9 2
♣ 9

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | 2NT | Pass | 3♦ |
| Pass | 3♥ | Pass | 4NT[1] |
| Pass | 5♥[2] | Pass | 6♥ |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

6♥ by North
Lead: ♣10

After NORTH opens 2NT, SOUTH is pretty sure there will be a slam in ♥s. But, the contract should be played from the NORTH side so the opening lead doesn't go through any vulnerable ♠ holding NORTH might have.

SOUTH transfers NORTH to ♥s, then uses Blackwood to be sure they aren't off two Aces. Missing one Ace he settles for 6♥.

***Board 2***
South Deals
None Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ K 9 8 5<br>♥ Q 7<br>♦ K 8 7<br>♣ J 9 6 5 | |
| ♠ J 10 2<br>♥ 10 8 6 2<br>♦ J 10 2<br>♣ 8 4 2 | N<br>W E<br>S | ♠ Q 7 4 3<br>♥ A 9 4<br>♦ Q 9 3<br>♣ A Q 3 |
| | ♠ A 6<br>♥ K J 5 3<br>♦ A 6 5 4<br>♣ K 10 7 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 1NT |
| Pass | 2♣ | Pass | 2♥ |
| Pass | 2NT | | |
| All Pass | | | |

2NT by South
Lead: ♣4

NORTH has an invitational hand, (9 points), after SOUTH's 1NT opening. With a 4-card ♠ suit she uses Stayman.

SOUTH then shows his 4-card ♥ suit.

With no ♥ fit, NORTH can only invite with 2NT, an invitation which SOUTH declines.

***Board 3***
South Deals
E-W Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ K 9 8 6 4<br>♥ A K 5 3<br>♦ J 8<br>♣ 6 4 | |
| ♠ 10 2<br>♥ 7 4<br>♦ Q 10 7 4<br>♣ A J 8 7 5 | N<br>W E<br>S | ♠ Q J 3<br>♥ 10 9 8 2<br>♦ 9 6 3<br>♣ K 3 2 |
| | ♠ A 7 5<br>♥ Q J 6<br>♦ A K 5 2<br>♣ Q 10 9 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 1NT |
| Pass | 2♣ | Pass | 2♦ |
| Pass | 3♠ | Pass | 4♠ |
| All Pass | | | |

4♠ by North
Lead: ♦3

Because NORTH holds a 4-card Major suit, (♥s), he starts his responses with Stayman.

SOUTH denies holding any 4-card Major suit so NORTH gives up on ♥s. He next bids ♠s, showing five of them. He jumps to 3♠, giving SOUTH the choice between 4♠ or 3NT.

With three trumps SOUTH chooses 4♠.

***Board 4***
South Deals
None Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ Q 8 6 5<br>♥ K 7 6 4<br>♦ A 3 2<br>♣ 5 4 | |
| ♠ J 9<br>♥ A 10 8 5<br>♦ K 10 8 7<br>♣ A 10 3 | N<br>W E<br>S | ♠ 10 4 2<br>♥ 9 3<br>♦ Q 9 6 4<br>♣ 9 8 7 2 |
| | ♠ A K 7 3<br>♥ Q J 2<br>♦ J 5<br>♣ K Q J 6 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 1NT |
| Pass | 2♣ | Pass | 2♠ |
| Pass | 3♠ | Pass | 4♠ |
| All Pass | | | |

4♠ by South
Lead: ♠J

NORTH has a poor 9 points, but does have two 4-card Majors. So he uses Stayman.

When SOUTH bids ♠s, NORTH isn't strong enough to bid game herself, so she temporizes with a 3♠ invitation.

SOUTH has a full 17 points so he accepts the invitation.

***Board 5***
North Deals
None Vul

♠ K Q
♥ A Q 7 5
♦ K 10 9
♣ Q J 8 4

♠ A 3 2
♥ K J
♦ J 8 4
♣ A K 9 6 3

♠ 9 4
♥ 10 8 6 4 3 2
♦ 7 6 3 2
♣ 5

♠ J 10 8 7 6 5
♥ 9
♦ A Q 5
♣ 10 7 2

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | 1NT | Pass | 2♥ |
| Pass | 2♠ | Pass | 3♠ |
| Pass | 4♠ | | |
| All Pass | | | |

4♠ by North
Lead: ♣5

SOUTH, with 9 points and a 6-card suit, knows they should play in ♠s. The question is: how high?

SOUTH transfers NORTH to ♠s, then invites by raising to 3♠.

NORTH has only two trumps, (good ones, admittedly), but she has a maximum 17 point hand. So she bids the ♠ game.